I was such a fan of Ralph Cordiner by then that I decided to reevaluate some of the things that the liberals (including me) had been saying about Nixon. Realizing after that that he wasn't the villain I'd thought him to be, I volunteered to campaign for him against Kennedy. I told Nixon I was going to register as a Republican, but he said I'd be more effective if I campaigned as a Democrat, and so I agreed not to change my party affiliation until after the election.

After hearing about my decision, John Kennedy's father, Joseph Kennedy, who spent a lot of time in Hollywood, asked to see me. He tried to persuade me to change my mind and support his son but I turned him down.

Although I agreed at Nixon's request not to register as a Republican, I was really no longer a Democrat by 1960.

I'd remain a Democrat for another two years, but by 1960 I had completed the process of self-conversion.

After that, the more I learned how some liberal Democrats wanted to rein in the energy of free enterprise and capitalism, create a welfare state, and impose a subtle kind of socialism, the more my view changed.

Upon reflection, I'm not so sure *I* changed as much as the parties changed.

One of the greatest of liberals, Thomas Jefferson, the founder of the Democratic Party, once remarked: "A wise and frugal government, which shall restrain men from injuring one another, shall leave them otherwise free to regulate their own pursuits of industry and improvement and shall not take from the mouth of labor the bread it has earned—this is the sum of good government."

My first vote at the age of twenty-one was for Franklin D. Roosevelt. His platform called for a twenty-five percent cut in federal spending and returning to people in the states and local communities authority and autonomy that had been taken over by the federal government. He also declared: "The federal government must and shall quit this